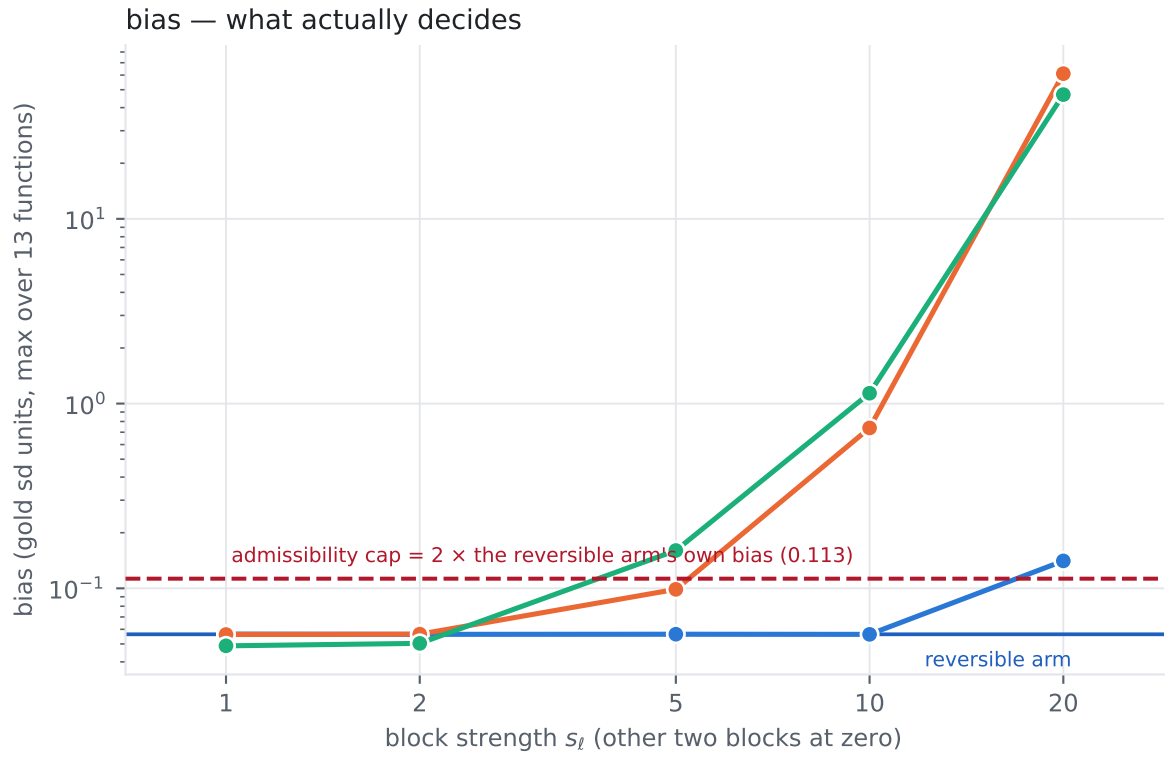
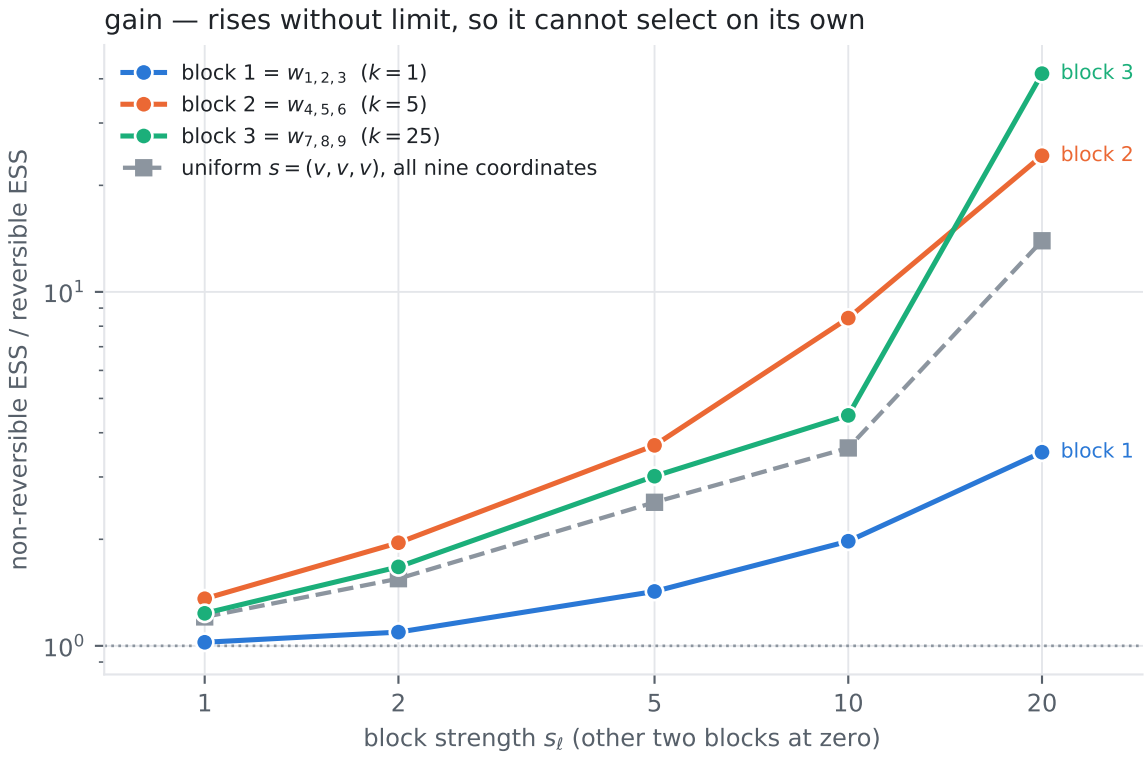


Stage A — per-block response, `graded` potential



TITANIC, ball constraint, eta = 0.0001, R = 32 coupled chains from a common stationary state sharing one Gaussian stream, 10000 measured iterations stored every 2, search seed 8100. Each curve scans ONE block's strength with the other two held at zero, so it is that block's own response. ESS from Geyer initial-positive/monotone IACT per chain per coordinate; the block ratio is the geometric mean over its three coordinates x all chains. Bias is measured against a reversible gold run at eta/10 over thirteen test functions (ten coordinates, $|w|^2$, U_0 , TRAINING accuracy -- no test labels). The left panel is exactly the trap: the gain never stops rising, so `argmax ESS` would pick $s = 20$ every time. The right panel shows what that costs.